

01

Company overview

Version 1.0 | Effective January 1, 2026

Northstar Labs is a fictional software company used for AI Support Agent demonstrations. These policies apply to all United States employees unless a page states otherwise.

PEOPLE OPERATIONS

Questions about benefits, leave, or employment records should be sent to people@northstarlabs.example. The team responds within two business days.

EMPLOYMENT RECORDS

Employees must update their home address, emergency contact, and tax elections in the People Portal within 10 calendar days of a change.

OFFICE ACCESS

Standard badge access is active Monday through Friday from 7:00 AM to 8:00 PM local time. Weekend access requires manager approval.

POLICY PRIORITY

If this handbook conflicts with a signed employment agreement or applicable law, the agreement or law controls. Employees should report conflicts to People Operations.

02

Vacation and leave

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Time away from work is planned to support employee wellbeing while keeping customer and project commitments covered.

VACATION ALLOWANCE

Full-time employees receive 20 vacation days per calendar year. Vacation accrues monthly at 1.67 days and is available after it appears in the People Portal.

CARRYOVER

Employees may carry over up to 5 unused vacation days into the next calendar year. Carried days expire on March 31 if they are not used.

SICK LEAVE

Full-time employees receive 10 paid sick days per calendar year. Sick leave does not carry over and does not require advance notice for an unexpected illness.

REQUEST TIMING

Vacation requests longer than 3 consecutive workdays should be submitted at least 14 calendar days in advance. Managers normally respond within 3 business days.

03

Flexible work

Version 1.0 | Effective January 1, 2026

Northstar uses a hybrid model designed to preserve focused work, reliable collaboration, and secure handling of company information.

HYBRID ELIGIBILITY

Employees become eligible for hybrid work after 90 days of employment and may work remotely up to 3 days per week with manager approval.

CORE COLLABORATION HOURS

All employees must be available from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM Eastern Time on scheduled workdays, excluding approved leave and local holidays.

EQUIPMENT STIPEND

Eligible employees may claim up to \$750 for approved home-office equipment once every 3 years. Receipts are required for reimbursement.

APPROVED LOCATIONS

Remote work is allowed only from a private location in the employee's country of employment. Working from another country requires written Legal and People Operations approval.

04

Expenses and security

Version 1.0 | Effective January 1, 2026

Employees are responsible for reasonable spending, timely documentation, and immediate reporting of risks to company systems or data.

EXPENSE DEADLINE

Business expenses must be submitted within 30 calendar days of purchase. Approved reimbursements are normally paid within 10 business days.

APPROVAL THRESHOLD

Any single expense above \$500 requires written manager approval before purchase. Air travel outside economy class also requires executive approval.

LOST DEVICES

A lost or stolen company device must be reported to security@northstarlabs.example within 1 hour of discovery, even outside normal business hours.

DATA HANDLING

Confidential customer data may be stored only in approved company systems. It must not be copied to personal email, consumer file-sharing services, or removable drives.